



Brilliant polychromatic decoration characterizes this detail of a rectangular Persian dish made in the 18th century during the Safavid dynasty.

THE GREAT NORTHERN WAR

(1700–21) between Sweden and Russia was brought to an end by the conclusion of the **Treaty of Nystad**. In 1719, Russia had successfully challenged Sweden's supremacy in the Baltic by attacking cities on the Swedish east coast. An alliance of the British and Swedes in 1719 then gave Sweden British navy protection that discouraged further raids. The Nystad Treaty restored Finland to Sweden, but former Swedish **Baltic territories** in Estonia and elsewhere went to

Deified ancestors

Moai were erected by clans on Easter Island to watch over their fields. This group, at Ahu Akivi, is the farthest inland.

Russia. Sweden was irrevocably diminished by the terms of the treaty, while Russia, with its new Baltic ports, now dominated Eastern Europe.

In one of the landmark moments of Dutch exploration, Jakob Roggeveen (1659–1729) set out in 1721 to find **Terra Australis**, the mysterious southern continent earlier mapped in part by Spaniard Juan Fernández and Dutchman Abel Tasman, among others. A former employee of the Dutch East Indies Company but now sponsored by its West Indies counterpart, Roggeveen and his three ships sailed to the Falkland Islands, Chile, and the Juan Fernández Islands. While crossing the South Pacific Ocean the following year,

the three ships chanced upon **Easter Island** (now Rapa Nui), so-named because it was discovered on Easter Sunday. Roggeveen also discovered the **Society Islands** and **Samoa** before returning home.

In 1722, the declining **Safavid dynasty** of Persia was deposed by **independent Afghans** to the east. Mahmud Hotaki (c. 1697–1725), son of Mirwais Khan Hotak (see 1709), brought an army to the Safavid capital of Isfahan, sacked the city, and proclaimed himself **shah of Persia**. It was not until 1729, and the defeat of the Hotaki dynasty by Afsharid Persians who were descended from the Mongols at the **Battle of Damghan**, that the Afghans were finally forced back to Kandahar.



“ **SLAVES WHO ARE DISABLED FROM WORKING ... SHALL BE ... PROVIDED FOR BY THEIR MASTERS.** ”

From the *Louisiana Code Noir*, 1724

EUROPEAN SUCCESS in procuring slaves in West Africa for transporting to the new colonies depended on the enthusiastic cooperation of certain tribes. In **Dahomey**, in what is now the Republic of Benin, King Agadja (r. 1708–40) presided over a culture of enslavement and human sacrifice. His conquest of neighboring Allada in 1723 provided a ready source of **captives for sale**, and by 1724 Dahomey had become the Europeans' principal source of slave labor.

In 1724, the **Code Noir**, King Louis XIV of France's extensive definition of the conditions of slavery, was introduced in the

French territory of Louisiana, North America. The code was partly intended to give slaves basic protection from their masters—all were to be given food and clothes, for example—but it also legitimized **cruel punishments**: runaway slaves were to be branded, their ears cut off, and, after a second offence, crippled by having their hamstrings cut.

Also in 1724, the disintegrating Mughal Empire saw the **Indian state of Oudh** gain independence under Saadat Ali Khan (c. 1680–1739). He founded the **Mughul Awadh dynasty**, which ruled until its power was seized by the British in the early 19th century.

April 4, 1721 German composer Johann Sebastian Bach (1685–1750) composes Brandenburg Concertos

August 1, 1721 Jakob Roggeveen sails to discover Terra Australis

November 2, 1721 Peter the Great proclaimed emperor of all the Russians

April 5, 1722 Jakob Roggeveen discovers Easter Island

October 23, 1722 Mahmud Hotaki acknowledged as shah of Persia

September 1, 1723 Treaty of St. Petersburg forces Persia to cede territory to Russia

January 14, 1724 Philip V of Spain abdicates the throne

1724 Asaf Jah seizes Hyderabad from Mughal control and makes himself Nizam of Hyderabad

1724 China expels foreign missionaries in retaliation for criticism from Pope Clement XI (see 1715)